



Inspection Report

BREC's Baton Rouge Zoo
3601 Thomas Road
Baton Rouge, LA 70807

Customer ID: **4769**

Certificate: **72-C-0179**

Site: 001

Brec's Baton Rouge Zoo

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION

Date: 17-AUG-2026

3.75(c)(1)(i)

Housing facilities, general.

The facility is not maintaining the shift doors for both species of macaques; the doors aren't free of excessive rust. The outer areas of the metal shift doors are reddish brown and have a pockmarked appearance. The metal bars attached to the cement wall that allow the door to shift open and closed are also a deep reddish brown with pocket marked areas. The non-human primates can come into contact with the rusted surfaces. Rusted primary enclosure surfaces can lose structural integrity over time and cannot be properly cleaned and sanitized. The licensee must ensure that any surfaces that come into contact with non-human primates are free of excessive rust that prevents the required cleaning and sanitization, or that affects the structural strength of the surfaces.

Correct by September 18, 2026

3.125(a)

Facilities, general.

The outdoor housing facilities for the goats are not being maintained in good repair to protect the animals from injury. The wood boards making up the barn doors to the goat's indoor area are deteriorating at the bottom. The wood is missing paint and has several splintered pieces creating sharp points. The damage is such that there is an obvious difference in thickness between the intact wood and the damaged wood. Failure to maintain housing facilities so that they are structurally sound and in good repair can increase the possibility of injury to the animals.

Correct by maintaining the housing facilities in good repair to protect the goats from injury.

3.126(a)

Facilities, indoor.

The facility failed to regulate the ambient temperatures and protect the animals from temperature extremes in the indoor portion of the enclosures for the two Spectacled Bears and the two Jaguars.

At the time of the inspection, at approximately 1 PM, USDA inspector felt a noticeable increase in temperature as they entered the building for the indoor enclosures of the two Jaguars and the two Spectacled Bears. Using the government issued Kestrel, USDA inspector measured a range of temperature inside the building from 124.9 to 127 degrees

Prepared By: SARAH ROLOFF

USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Title: COMPLIANCE SPECIALIST

Date:

18-AUG-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative

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Fahrenheit. The facility representative was unsure if the air conditioning was broken by the bears or if the building didn't have AC.

The Spectacled Bears are housed exclusively outdoors for exhibition hours during the day, and the jaguars have access to both the outdoor and indoor portions of their enclosure during the day. Both the bears and the jaguars are confined only to the indoor portion of this enclosure after exhibition hours and at night. The facility reports that they have been doing nothing differently overnight to mitigate the high temperatures.

At 10am on August 17, 2026, the National Weather Service recorded a temperature for the area of 88 degrees F with a heat index at 102 degrees F. At 4 pm the temperature had risen to 96.1 degrees F with a heat index of 108 degrees F. From 7 pm to 10 am (the evening of August 17, 2026, to the morning of August 18, 2026), the National Weather Service recorded temperatures ranging from 90 to 87.1 degrees F with a heat index of 97 degrees F to 99 degrees F respectively. Neither species had the option to escape the heat while in the indoor portion of the enclosure, however, they didn't exhibit signs of heat distress. After speaking with the USDA inspector, the facility intends to leave doors open to increase airflow at night. Prolonged exposure to extreme temperatures can be detrimental to the health of the animals and cause discomfort.

The facility must ensure that indoor housing facilities be sufficiently regulated by heating or cooling to protect the animals from extremes of temperature and to provide for their health and prevent their discomfort.

Correct by August 24, 2026

3.131(c)

Sanitation.

The facility is not keeping the premises clean and in good repair in order to protect the animals from injury and to facilitate the prescribed husbandry practices set forth in this subpart.

The building housing the ambassador animals such as prairie dogs, chinchillas, and a ferret was in disarray with animal enclosures placed behind and amongst storage and building materials, enrichment materials, office supplies, and other paraphernalia. In an HVAC closet across from the chinchilla enclosure, the USDA inspector identified an accumulation of rodent feces, discarded lettuce and hay. The accumulation of additional materials can provide areas that harbor disease-transmitting pests that could be health risks to the animals. Additionally, the building housing a male Zebra had an excessive accumulation of cobwebs in the rafters, on the ceilings and around the box fans. The box fan had a thick layer of brown dust over the front panel. Accumulations of dust and cobwebs indicate inadequate cleaning and the presence of pests that may pose health risks to the animals.

Correct by ensuring that premises (buildings and grounds) are kept clean, in good repair and accumulations of trash are placed in designated areas and cleared as necessary in order to protect the animals from injury, protect their health, and to facilitate prescribed husbandry practices.

Correct by September 18, 2026

3.154

Prepared By: SARAH ROLOFF

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Environment enhancement to promote psychological well-being.

The facility does not have an environmental enhancement plan (EEP) approved by the current attending veterinarian. The current attending veterinarian started on June 8, 2026, and has not approved the environmental enhancement plan. Failure to implement and follow an EEP as outlined can negatively impact the health and well-being of the animals. Exhibitors must develop, document, and follow a species-appropriate plan for environmental enhancement that is approved by the attending veterinarian to adequately promote the psychological well-being of birds.

Correct by August 31, 2026.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with a facility representative.

Prepared By: SARAH ROLOFF
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title: COMPLIANCE SPECIALIST

Date:
18-AUG-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative

Date:
18-AUG-2026



Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
4769	72-C-0179	001	Brec's Baton Rouge Zoo	17-AUG-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000002	<i>Macaca nigra</i>	SULAWESI CRESTED MACAQUE
000003	<i>Colobus guereza</i>	EASTERN BLACK-AND-WHITE COLOBUS / GUEREZA
000001	<i>Macaca silenus</i>	LION-TAILED MACAQUE
000003	<i>Ateles geoffroyi</i>	BLACK-HANDED SPIDER MONKEY
000003	<i>Symphalangus syndactylus</i>	SIAMANG
000002	<i>Bos taurus</i>	CATTLE / COW / OX
000010	<i>Capra hircus</i>	DOMESTIC GOAT
000002	<i>Ovis aries</i>	SHEEP INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS
000003	<i>Oryctolagus cuniculus</i>	DOMESTIC RABBIT / EUROPEAN RABBIT
000002	<i>Chrysocyon brachyurus</i>	MANED WOLF
000002	<i>Acinonyx jubatus</i>	CHEETAH
000002	<i>Panthera onca</i>	JAGUAR
000003	<i>Lynx rufus</i>	BOBCAT
000004	<i>Panthera tigris</i>	TIGER
000012	<i>Cynomys ludovicianus</i>	BLACK-TAILED PRAIRIE DOG
000002	<i>Eudorcas thomsonii</i>	THOMSON'S GAZELLE
000002	<i>Hippotragus niger</i>	SABLE ANTELOPE
000005	<i>Odocoileus virginianus</i>	WHITE-TAILED DEER
000006	<i>Capra nubiana</i>	NUBIAN IBEX
000001	<i>Tolypeutes matacus</i>	SOUTHERN THREE-BANDED ARMADILLO
000001	<i>Pteropus giganteus</i>	INDIAN FLYING FOX
000004	<i>Giraffa camelopardalis</i>	GIRAFFE
000002	<i>Hexaprotodon liberiensis</i>	PYGMY HIPPOPOTAMUS
000001	<i>Osphranter rufus</i>	RED KANGAROO
000002	<i>Lontra canadensis</i>	NORTH AMERICAN RIVER OTTER
000003	<i>Mustela putorius</i>	EUROPEAN POLECAT
000002	<i>Diceros bicornis</i>	BLACK RHINOCEROS
000002	<i>Rhinoceros unicornis</i>	INDIAN RHINOCEROS
000003	<i>Tapirus bairdii</i>	BAIRD'S TAPIR
000001	<i>Echinops telfairi</i>	LESSER MADAGASCAR HEDGEHOG TENREC
000002	<i>Chinchilla lanigera</i>	CHINCHILLA (DOMESTICATED)
000004	<i>Guinea Pigs</i>	GUINEA PIGS
000001	<i>Cervus canadensis</i>	ELK / WAPITI
000006	<i>Bison bison</i>	AMERICAN BISON
000001	<i>Struthio camelus</i>	COMMON OSTRICH
000002	<i>Casuarus casuarus</i>	SOUTHERN CASSOWARY / DOUBLE-WATTLED CASSOWARY
000002	<i>Dromaius novaehollandiae</i>	EMU
000001	<i>Guttera pucherani</i>	EASTERN CRESTED GUINEAFOWL
000001	<i>Colinus virginianus</i>	NORTHERN BOBWHITE
000001	<i>Meleagris gallopavo domesticus</i>	DOMESTIC TURKEY
000002	<i>Balearica regulorum</i>	GRAY CROWNED-CRANE / AFRICAN CROWNED-CRANE / GOLDEN CROWNED-CRANE
000003	<i>Gallus varius</i>	GREEN JUNGLEFOWL
000002	<i>Phasianus colchicus</i>	RING-NECKED PHEASANT / COMMON PHEASANT
000003	<i>Pavo cristatus</i>	INDIAN PEAFOWL / COMMON PEAFOWL / PEAHEN / PEACOCK
000003	<i>Ducula bicolor</i>	PIED IMPERIAL-PIGEON
000002	<i>Chauna torquata</i>	SOUTHERN SCREAMER / CRESTED SCREAMER
000003	<i>Threskiornis aethiopicus</i>	AFRICAN SACRED IBIS



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000001	<i>Dendrocygna bicolor</i>		FULVOUS WHISTLING-DUCK	
000004	<i>Anser anser domesticus</i>		DOMESTIC GOOSE	
000001	<i>Anas acuta</i>		NORTHERN PINTAIL	
000014	<i>Anas platyrhynchos domesticus</i>		DOMESTIC DUCK INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS	
000001	<i>Callonetta leucophrys</i>		RINGED TEAL	
000010	<i>Phoenicopterus chilensis</i>		CHILEAN FLAMINGO	
000004	<i>Caloenas nicobarica</i>		NICOBAR PIGEON	
000002	<i>Goura victoria</i>		VICTORIA CROWNED-PIGEON	
000001	<i>Tauraco persa</i>		GUINEA TURACO	
000004	<i>Musophaga rossae</i>		ROSS'S TURACO	
000002	<i>Porphyrio poliocephalus</i>		GRAY-HEADED SWAMPHEN	
000002	<i>Ciconia abdimii</i>		ABDIM'S STORK	
000001	<i>Leptoptilos crumenifer</i>		MARABOU STORK	
000004	<i>Platalea alba</i>		AFRICAN SPOONBILL	
000009	<i>Platalea ajaja</i>		ROSEATE SPOONBILL	
000001	<i>Strix varia</i>		BARRED OWL	
000002	<i>Sarcoramphus papa</i>		KING VULTURE	
000001	<i>Vultur gryphus</i>		ANDEAN CONDOR	
000002	<i>Haliaeetus leucocephalus</i>		BALD EAGLE	
000001	<i>Buceros rhinoceros</i>		RHINOCEROS HORNBILL	
000002	<i>Bucorvus leadbeateri</i>		SOUTHERN GROUND-HORNBILL	
000003	<i>Dacelo novaeguineae</i>		LAUGHING KOOKABURRA	
000002	<i>Caracara plancus</i>		CRESTED CARACARA	
000001	<i>Eclectus roratus</i>		ECLECTUS PARROT	
000002	<i>Amazona auropalliata</i>		YELLOW-NAPED PARROT / YELLOW-NAPED AMAZON	
000003	<i>Ara ararauna</i>		BLUE-AND-YELLOW MACAW / BLUE-AND-GOLD MACAW	
000002	<i>Ara chloropterus</i>		RED-AND-GREEN MACAW / GREEN-WINGED MACAW	
000002	<i>Ara macao</i>		SCARLET MACAW	
000002	<i>Ara militaris</i>		MILITARY MACAW	
000005	<i>Ara rubrogenys</i>		RED-FRONTED MACAW	
000002	<i>Eolophus roseicapilla</i>		GALAH / ROSE-BREASTED COCKATOO / ROSEATE COCKATOO	
000001	<i>Cacatua galerita</i>		SULPHUR-CRESTED COCKATOO / GREATER SULPHUR-CRESTED COCKATOO	
000002	<i>Corvus albicollis</i>		WHITE-NECKED RAVEN	
000004	<i>Cyanopica cyanus</i>		AZURE-WINGED MAGPIE	
000001	<i>Mycteria americana</i>		WOOD STORK	
000002	<i>Tremarctos ornatus</i>		SPECTACLED BEAR	
000005	<i>Equus quagga</i>		BURCHELL'S / GRANT'S / CHAPMAN'S / PLAINS ZEBRA	
000003	<i>Potamochoerus porcus</i>		RED RIVER HOG	
000004	<i>Nanger dama</i>		ADDRA GAZELLE	
000004	<i>Oryx dammah</i>		SCIMITAR-HORNED ORYX	
000002	<i>Gallus gallus</i>		RED JUNGLEFOWL	
000003	<i>Aythya baeri</i>		BAER'S POCHARD	
000004	<i>Tadorna cana</i>		SOUTH AFRICAN SHELDUCK	
000002	<i>Spatula cyanoptera</i>		CINNAMON TEAL	
000001	<i>Antigone canadensis</i>		SANDHILL CRANE	
000002	<i>Anthropoides virgo</i>		DEMOISELLE CRANE	
000002	<i>Geronticus eremita</i>		NORTHERN BALD IBIS	
000001	<i>Tyto alba</i>		BARN OWL / WESTERN BARN OWL / AMERICAN BARN OWL / EASTERN BARN OWL	



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4769	72-C-0179	001	Brec's Baton Rouge Zoo	17-AUG-2026
000001	<i>Megascops asio</i>		EASTERN SCREECH-OWL	
000001	<i>Buteo jamaicensis</i>		RED-TAILED HAWK	
000268	Total			